THE LINKEDIN ALGORITHM IN 2025

What actually moves the needle

Reach • Engagement • Formats • Strategy

DESIGNED FOR

Students & young professionals , Job seekers building their brand,

Content creators & marketers, HR & recruiters seeking reach

Sources: Algorithm InSights 2025 (van der Blom) • Agorapulse 2025 • Postiv AI 2025–26

THE BIG PICTURE

Organic reach is down — but quality still wins

-50%
Avg views per post 2024 → 2025

-25%
Overall engagement drop

-59%
Follower growth rate decline

+12%
Engagement for high-value posts

What this means for you:

- **Algorithm got selective, not random**
  Niche, high-quality posts outperform viral bait
- **Bad content dropped hard**
  Generic, AI-filler & promo posts saw steepest declines
- **Quality content beat the trend**
  High-value posts saw +12% engagement (est.)

Source: Algorithm InSights 2025 (van der Blom), cited in Agorapulse 2025 LinkedIn Report

HOW IT WORKS

Every post passes 3 algorithm gates

1

Quality & Spam Filter

AI checks:is it clear,professional, spam-free? Bait & filler get flagged.

2

Early Distribution Test

Shown to ~2–5 % of audience first. First 60–90 min are critical.

3

Relevance Scaling

Passes test ? Distributed to people most likely to care (2–3 week lifespan).

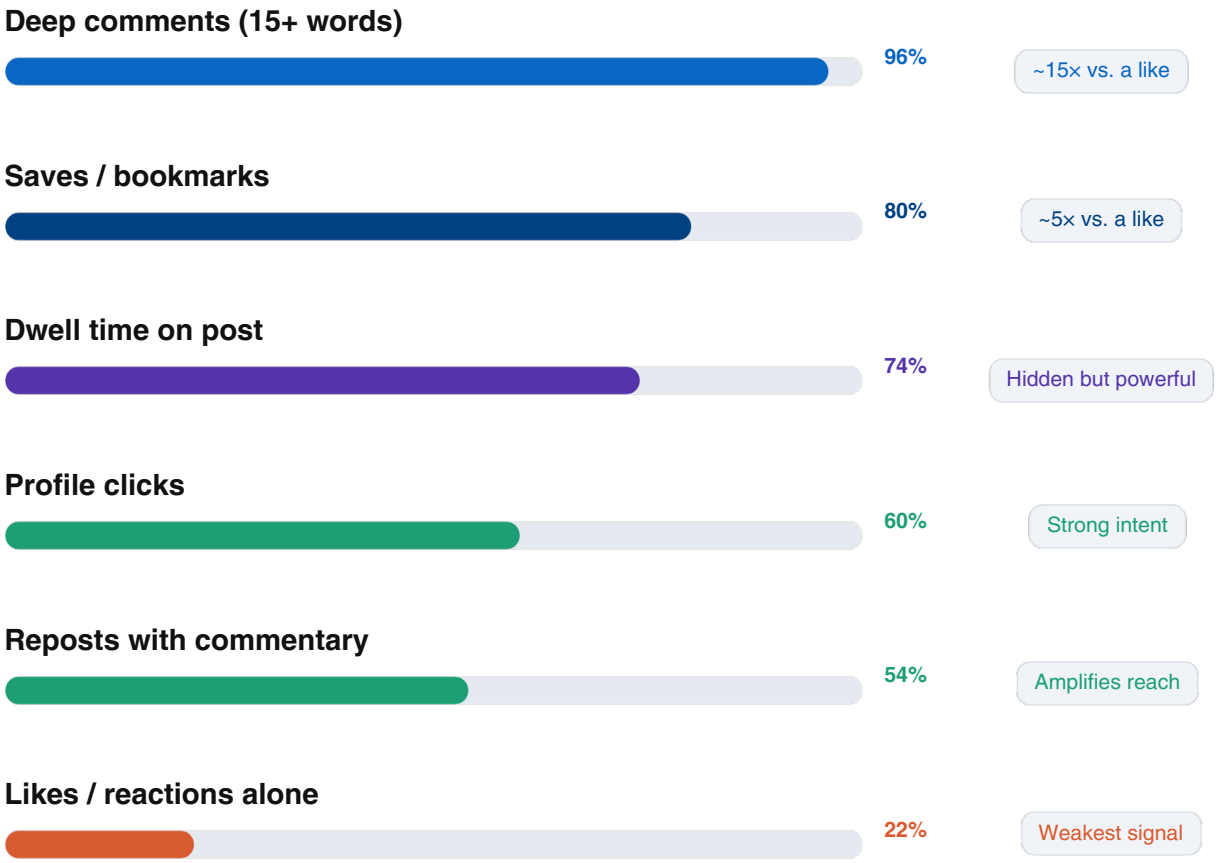
TIP

Think of it as a trust filter. Great posts earn their way through each gate.

Source: SourceGeek Jan 2026 • Postiv AI 2025–26 • LinkedIn Engineering guidance

ENGAGEMENT SIGNALS

Not all engagement is equal



Source: AuthoredUp 621,833-post study, cited in Algorithm InSights 2025 (van der Blom)

CONTENT FORMATS

Format matters as much as content

BEST

PDF Carousels

~6.6% avg eng. rate

Highest saves + dwell. 1.45–1.9× reach boost.

GREAT

TextPosts

Strong if specific

Personal stories + hooks + niche beats generic.

GOOD

Native Images

1.21× reach boost

Charts & real photos beat stock images.

GOOD

Polls

1.64× reach (personal)

Genuine questions spark comments.

CAUTION

Native Video

Reach down ~200% YoY

Heavily deprioritised in 2025.

AVOID

External Links

–30 to 60% reach

Always move URLs to first comment.

Source: Postiv AI 2025–26 (2M+ posts) • AuthoredUp study • Agorapulse 2025 Benchmarks

TIMING

The first 90 minutes decide everything

0 min	0–90 min	Day 1–2	Week 2–3
Post published & classified	~2–5% test audience	Wider relevant distribution	Relevance phase (not recency)

90-min action checklist:

- **Post Tue–Thu, 8–10 AM or 12–2 PM**
  When your audience is most active (directional est.)
- **Reply to every comment within 90 min**
  Your own replies keep the thread alive
- **Never edit in the first hour**
  Edits reset the early distribution clock
- **All links go in the first comment**
  Post body links cut reach ~30% (Postiv AI 2025)

Source: Algorithm InSights 2025 (van der Blom) • Postiv AI 2025 • SourceGeek Jan 2026

PERSONAL vs COMPANY

The first 90 minutes decide everything

PERSONAL PROFILE

Reach/follower
~10× more vs. company

Feed share
~59% of total feed

B2B buyer trust
92% trust personal voices

CTR
~2× vs. company posts

Best use
Thought leadership & expertise

COMPANY PAGE

Organic reach
~1.6% of followers avg

Feed share
Only ~1–2% of feed

Reach trend
Down 60–66% since 2021

Engagement
~5× lower than personal

Best use
Trust anchor & info hub

TIP
Use company page as credibility anchor. Build reach from personal accounts of founders & team.

Source: Algorithm InSights 2025 (van der Blom) • Agorapulse 2025 • DesignACE Feb 2026

DO'S & DON'TS

What the algorithm rewards & punishes

DO THIS

- Niche expertise with real examples
- Personal failures & lessons learned
- Genuine questions at post end
- PDF carousels with takeaways

AVOID THIS

- Generic motivational advice
- Engagement bait ("Comment YES")
- AI-sounding templated copy
- External links in post body

Failures & lesson posts outperform success posts by 5–7× in comments. (Postiv AI 2025)

Source: Postiv AI 2025 • SourceGeek Jan 2026 • Agorapulse 2025 • LinkedIn Eng. guidance

POSTING STRATEGY

Consistency beats frequency

The algorithm tracks topical authority — expertise in your niche.

1

Choose 1–2 topics to own

Nicheexpertsoutperformgeneralists. Pick your lane.

2

Post 3–5× per week (personal)

Overpostinglowersper-postreach.Quality > volume.

3

Track comments & saves — not likes

Thesearetherealsignals.15+wordcommentsmatter most.

4

Build topical authority over 4–8 weeks

Consistency compounds. Early posts boostlater ones.

5

Tag max 3–5 relevant people only

Irrelevanttaggingistreatedasspamandsuppresses reach.

Source: Postiv AI 2025–26 • Algorithm InSights 2025 • DesignACE Feb 2026

POSTING STRATEGY

How to write posts the algorithm loves

Hook anatomy — first ~210 characters

LinkedIn shows only ~210 characters before 'See more'. Your opening line must earn the click.

WEAK

I want to share some LinkedIn strategy thoughts today.

STRONG

I lost 3,000 followers in a week. Here's what I learned.

4 rules for 2025:

- **Short paragraphs & white space**
  Scannable structure = longer dwell time
- **Be specific, not generic**
  '$5–20M SaaS on LinkedIn' beats 'business tips'
- **Sound human — not templated**
  Algorithm flags AI-sounding filler as low-quality
- **End with a real question**
  'Not 'Agree?' — something people answer from experience

Source: SourceGeek Jan 2026 • Postiv AI 2025 • Agorapulse 2025 LinkedIn Report

WRITING & HOOKS

Saves: the most underrated metric

~5×	~2×	+130%	3 wks
Weight vs. 1 like	Weight vs. 1 comment	Follow chance after save	Lifespan of highly-saved post

Source: AuthoredUp 621,833-post study, cited in Algorithm InSights 2025

How to create save-worthy content:

- **Frameworks & checklists**
  Structured summaries people return to later
- **Step-by-step breakdowns**
  Clear sequences are bookmarked constantly
- **Data-backed insights**
  Numbers make posts worth saving as reference
- **Industry trend analysis**
  Niche observations no one else is publishing

TIP
Before posting ask: 'Would someone bookmark this later?' If no — add a stronger takeaway.

Source: Algorithm InSights 2025 (van der Blom) • LinkedIn post analytics update, late 2025

CHEAT SHEET

Your 2025 algorithm cheat sheet

Pass quality gate
No bait, no AIfiller, no links in post body

Win the 90-min window
Reply to every comment within 90 minutes

Maximise saves
Post frameworks & breakdowns people keep

Use PDF carousels
Highest eng.(~6.6%) + saves + dwell time

Post from personal profile
Not company page — ~10× more reach/follower

Stay niche & consistent
Topicalauthoritycompoundsover 4–8 weeks

Links → first comment
Body links cut reach ~30%. Always.

Sources

Algorithm InSights 2025 — Richard van der Blom (2025 primary research)
Agorapulse 2025 LinkedIn Report — agorapulse.com (Sept 2025, upd. Feb 2026)
Postiv AI 2025–26 Analysis — postiv.ai (2M+ posts dataset)
AuthoredUp 621,833-post study — cited in Algorithm InSights 2025
SourceGeek LinkedIn Algorithm 2026 Update — sourcegeek.com (Jan 2026)
DesignACE LinkedIn Algorithm 2026 — designace.ca (Feb 2026)

Note: Stats labelled est. are directional. Primary van der Blom report is commercially published; numbers cited via secondary sources above.